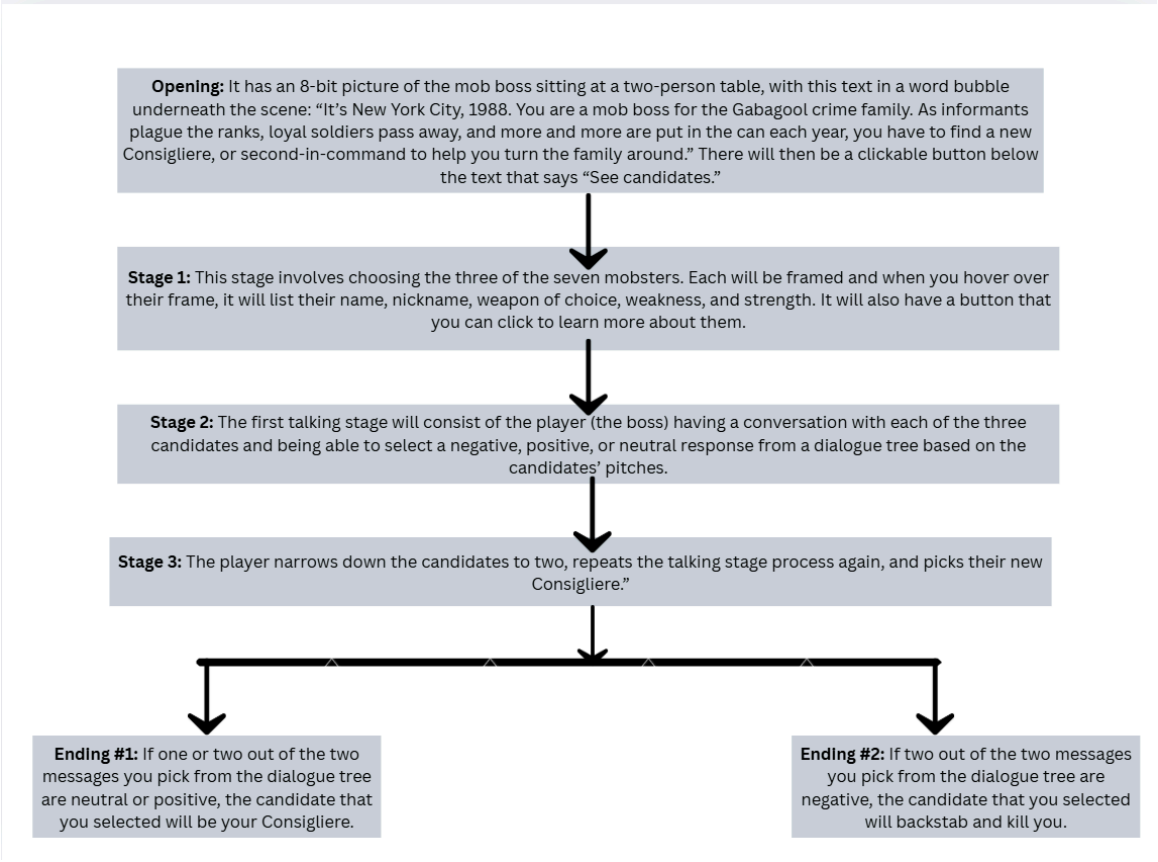
Introduce the game

Working title: Consigliere Finder.

Representative visual:



Description of player experience: In Consigliere Finder, you are an Italian Mob Boss trying to find a new Consigliere: your second-in-command. You will first choose three possible mob captains to promote from a pool of 7. You will then go through two stages of talking periods with each captain and depending on your conversations, you decide who moves on to the next round. The captain left after the two elimination stages is your new Consigliere.

Present your case study

Game I played: The Ratchelor.

Creator credits: Algorat is the team that created “The Rachelor” as well as its two sequels. The team is made up of Connie Ye, Tatyana Mustakos, Char Stiles, and Caroline Hermans. It was started by Caroline Hermans and the rats and items in the game look to be hand-drawn.

Three meaningful moments:

1. Giving roses: After chit-chatting, you have to give roses to the contestants you want to continue on.
2. Choosing the contestants you start with: At the beginning, you must choose a set number of contestants out of a large pool. Each one has a little blurb under their picture that appears when your mouse hovers over them.
3. Proposal: Giving the final rose away, the “propose to [Name]” button comes up and it shows a photo of you and the rat you chose on the beach, with you kneeling.

Five player-action events

1. Dialogue tree: During the chit-chat round, you are given a dialogue tree. The message you select determines the mood of each rat.
2. You can give flowers to the rats that you want to move on. These rats then remain on the show and the ones that weren’t given the rose aren’t seen again.
3. Several emoji-like rat heads come up from the rats' heads after you choose a message, and their expressions vary based on your message.
4. Once you’ve eliminated down to the last rat, the “propose to [Name]” button comes up and it shows a photo of you and the rat you chose on the beach, with you kneeling.
5. In the beginning of the simulation, you pick seven rats out of the 15. These rats are the ones that you want to move on to the chit-chat stage.

Document your critical discussion with AI

Two gaps found in The Ratchelor by players:

1. **Lore accessibility:** Players noted that there was a lack of lore accessibility to the interesting contestants you could choose from.
2. **Limited dialogue impact:** Players noted that there wasn’t really an impact on gameplay based on your dialogue to the contestants, outside of the emojis that appeared above their heads once you spoke.

Source: https://shapes.inc/fandom/the-ratchelor-a-rat-dating-sim/deep-dive

Solutions:

1. **Lore accessibility:** I'm going to make it a point to help the player understand each mobster's lore by having a little bio of each mobster available when you click "Bio" on the screen where you choose your three mobsters. This will send you to a separate scene where it zooms in on the mobster's face and has a rectangular box to the right that has a paragraph about them, their upbringing, how they got their nickname, etc.

2. **Limited dialogue impact:** I will make the dialogue more impactful by giving the mobster the option of backstabbing you if you give them disrespectful responses and then choose them to be your Consigliere. If you give them decent/goof responses, they will accept the position. With this, there is a little at stake.

Explain your narrative and concept

Interpretation of Hallucination: I think that Hallucination, like a lot of the other AI software that we have been using, requires a lot of specific rules to create a desired product, which is good. I believe it will be a great guide when it comes to step-by-step production of the game.

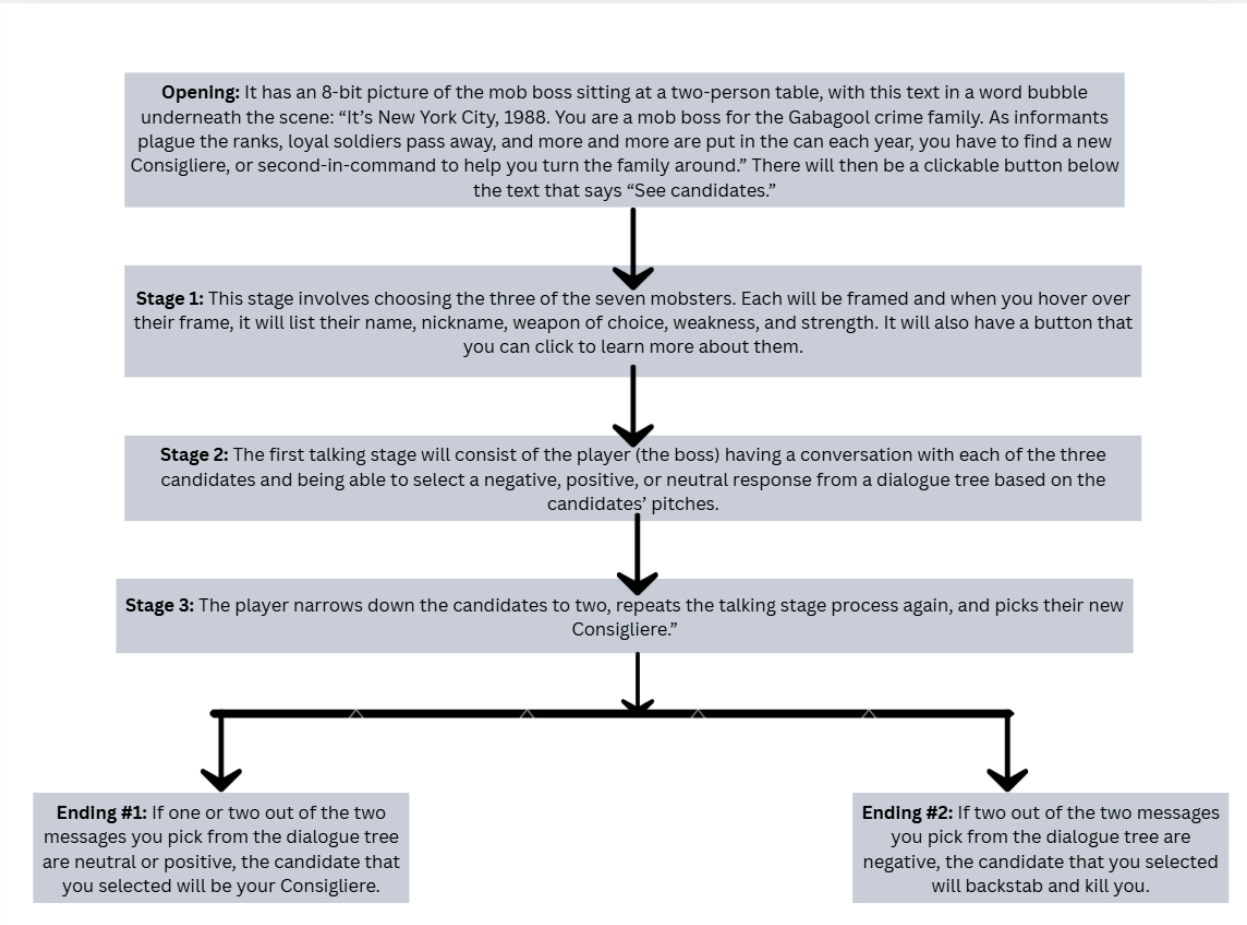
Game world: I want the same style as The Ratchelor where there is wallpaper in the background, and the actual game happens within a frame. You are able to change the volume on the side of the frame and can click through the game by interacting with things inside of the frame only. The frame is in the middle of the screen and takes up 70% of the screen.

The game world is limited; you can't really travel anywhere, and the settings are the mob hang-out spot (where you and the prospects converse), a field of grass (where you choose who stays and who is eliminated). The different stages of the game determine the different environments you are in. You cannot go back or control what environment you go to. It is not an open world.

Player's role: The player's role is simple: narrow the candidates down to pick your ideal second-in-command.

Experience: I want to create an experience where the player can see the creativity behind all 7 possible mobsters. I want the player to match their values and their idea of a perfect second-in-charge through the mobsters' traits, personalities, characteristics, and communication. I want this to not be a game you can win, but a game where you get what you want: your perfect Consigliere.

Show the interaction and player journey:



Present a style and sound guide: annotated references with credits and explanations of your visual, interface, motion, and audio choices.

Visual: 8-bit character style such as this:



The frames, wallpaper, and soundbar will have that self-drawn style, which is apparent in The Ratchelor.

Interface and motion: There will be no interface and motion in this game because like The Ratchelor, it is a simulation.

Audio choices: The stages where you pick the three candidates and select which candidates move on will be the Jeopardy theme song:

Griffin, M. (1964). *Think!* [Theme music].

The stages while you are talking to the candidates, the opening scene, as well as the candidate acceptance / backstab scene have *The Sopranos* theme song:

Alabama 3. (1997). Woke up this morning [Song]. On *Exile on Coldharbour Lane*. One Little Indian.

Describe your two-week build plan:

What I will build in Week 2 and refine in Week 3:

1. Mobsters

- I will ask AI to create pixels versions of 10 mobsters from The Sopranos.

- I will input each mobster's info such as their name, nickname, hometown, weapon of choice, strengths, weaknesses, and bio.

- Input what each will say in each of the two talking stages. Two messages will be written for each to prepare each for if they are selected twice. A third message will be prepared for each mobster, which will cover what they will say after the player picks them to be their concierge

2. Webpage design

- Wallpaper and framing designs (color, texture, size, etc)

- Soundbar (Dragging up = higher sound, dragging down = lower sound)

3. Environments

- Mob hangout (same layout as the butcher shop hangout in The Sopranos)

- Wall with all of the candidates' portraits.

- Candidate acceptance / backstab scene.

4. Dialogue tree options

- Three types of responses: negative, positive, and neutral to candidates' pitches. There will be one of each response, three options in total, but they will be randomly selected for each dialogue tree.